

Kevin Trayner

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Summary

Product & Strategic Design Leader with 20+ years driving experience architecture, design governance, and customer-centric strategies for Fortune 100 enterprise ecosystems. Proven track record translating complex business models into seamless digital products that scale to 30M+ users. Expert at bridging CX, product, and executive stakeholders to accelerate time-to-market, reduce friction, and increase revenue.

Core Competencies

- **Design & Strategy:** Product Design, Experience Architecture, Service Design, Design Systems and Governance, Journey Mapping.
- **Leadership & Execution:** Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Agile/SDLC, Friction Audits, Stakeholder Alignment, Design Mentorship.
- **Tools & Artifacts:** Figma Component Libraries, Wireframing & Prototyping, Generative AI for UX (Gemini, Claude Code, Copilot)

Relevant Work Experience

- **Operate as a senior, autonomous experience strategist, capable of owning ambiguous problem spaces end-to-end without the need for program management support**
- Led and owned end-to-end design strategy for mobile digital products at Verizon Consumer Group as Principal Experience Designer, defining complex business rules with limited program management support.
[Case Study: Redesign our core mobile plans architecture from early concept through to delivery](#)
- **Identify opportunity areas proactively - treating work as an internal consultancy, shaping what we should work on, not just how**
- **Recognize when user research will be impactful, right-size the approach, execute the research, and translate findings into clear strategic direction and business recommendations**
- **Drive experience strategy upstream, shaping problem framing, success metrics, and North Star design concepts before delivery begins**
- **Build strong relationships with your Product and Engineering pod-based team, sharing accountability for outcomes that ship**
- **Support creative and product teams with clear strategic direction, experience principles, and decision frameworks, not just insights**
- **Leverage AI and emerging tools to accelerate early concepting and strategic exploration (e.g., rapid concept generation, scenario modeling, early experience articulation)**
- **Keep track of product roadmaps and business priorities to identify intersections**

with user needs and surface strategic tradeoffs early. Shape the pod's prioritization approach to determine which work gets done.

- **Package and present insights, designs, and recommendations in persuasive, executive-ready narratives** - strong presence and storytelling skills are essential
- **Insert user insight into designs and product decisions, challenging assumptions and influencing prioritization, feasibility tradeoffs, and roadmap direction**
- **Contribute hands-on where valuable** — including early experience models, journey maps, concepts, or lightweight design artifacts
- **Inspire and lead with an entrepreneurial mindset, pushing work forward, creating momentum, and raising the strategic bar by becoming trusted partners to our stakeholders**

Professional Experience

Verizon Consumer Group (VCG) - Basking Ridge, NJ

Lead design strategist/designer on VCG Design team for Mobile and other digital products.

Principal Experience Designer / Experience Architect (2024 – Present)

- **Strategic Experience Architecture:** Lead end-to-end design strategy for mobile products, turning complex business rules into simple digital journeys for customers.
- **Design System & Process Governance:** Created reusable Figma templates and offer systems to help the team launch new promotions faster.
- **Cross-Functional Alignment & Stakeholder Leadership:** Led collaborative workshops with business, product, and design leaders to solve technical issues and align cross-channel strategies.
- **Mentorship & Practice Development:** Mentored junior and mid-level designers on design skills, system thinking, and presentations - to foster a design-led culture.

Lead Experience Architect / UX Designer (2021 – 2024)

- **Flagship Product Strategy (myPlans):** Redesigned the main "myPlan" offerings to simplify customer choices and encourage higher-value plans. Smoothed out friction and increased conversion for customers adding a line, by clearly indicating the low cost of adding a 3rd line, adding \$8.4M/mo in revenue.
- **Revenue & Margin Optimization:** Managed design updates for complex perk pricing restructures (Apple One, Disney, Netflix/Max), preserving high-margin offerings while migrating legacy users to minimize churn.
- **Market Performance Acceleration:** Led CX updates for connected device plans (tablets and smartwatches), directly contributing to tablet premium plan activations performing 3.3% above forecast.
- **Strategic Research:** Led competitive 'Secret Shopper' audits on competitor upgrade flows, surfacing hidden fees and frictions to inform Verizon senior leadership on strategic positioning.
- **Regulatory Design:** Spearheaded the UX design and cross-platform implementation for FCC-mandated product labels across all mobile and home services.

Senior UX Designer (2016 – 2021)

- Optimized the Learn & Buy sales funnel on Verizon.com, enhancing web and mobile journeys for 32M+ active users.
- Delivered high-fidelity wireframes, interactive prototypes, and user flows in close collaboration with development and brand teams.

Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu - Princeton, NJ

Lead designer/business analyst of internal systems for the largest professional services firm worldwide, used by 15,000 audit and assurance professionals worldwide.

Senior Business Analyst/Designer (2010 – 2016)

- Managed user requirements and experience design for internal software used by 80,000 professionals across 32 countries.
- Facilitated regular usability and UAT sessions with real users to validate core features against technical constraints.

User Experience Designer (2004 – 2010)

- Designed enterprise web/desktop applications, delivering wireframes, process flows, site maps, and UI pattern libraries.
- Wrote comprehensive user guides and support materials to help employees worldwide adopt new software.

Multimedia Specialist (2001 – 2004)

- Developed interactive product demos and visual prototypes to support global software rollouts.

Technical Writer (1995 – 2001)

- Authored user documentation and help guides for desktop applications serving 20,000 global users.

Other Experience (pre- 2000s)

Instructional Designer — Eduneering

Small, start up tech consulting firm, specializing in regulatory training for energy, food manufacturing and pharma industries. (Owned by UL Solutions today).

- Designed interactive computer-based training modules for Fortune 500 clients in the energy and telecommunications industries.

Editor — Cranbury Publications

- Managed production, design, and writing staff for local newspapers and oversaw the startup of a new publication.

Certifications & Education

- **Google AI Professional Certificate** — Coursera / Google (2026)
- **Generative AI for UX Design & Prototyping** (Gemini, Claude Code, Copilot, Figma)
- **BA in English / Communications** — Ursinus College, Collegeville, PA

Leadership and Publications

- **Board of Trustees** — Murray Grove Retreat Center, Lanoka Harbor, NJ. Provide oversight strategic direction, and governance for a 20 acre retreat focused on radical hospitality.
- **Published Author & Columnist** — Author of *Beer Drinker's Handbook* | Columnist for Ale Street News.